

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3227

Name

Zhaoying Ma

Emailzhaoying.ma@materials.ox.ac.uk**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Oxford, United Kingdom

Nationality

Chinese

When did or will you finish your PhD?

2024.02

University Education

DPhil in Materials, University of Oxford, 2020.10-2024.02

B.E. in Materials Chemistry, University of Science and Technology Beijing, 2016.09-2020.06

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I have always had a passion towards teaching and outreaching, and have been actively participating in such activities in the past years. However, all the work I have been doing was local and more educationally well-sourced. So I am eager to be placed at places where I can bring my enthusiasm in teaching into a meaningful project while I can also experience a different culture at the same time. I have read about Science Corp in my second year and have been paying attention since. Shortly afterwards, one of my colleagues applied to be a fellow and is about to leave for Bangladesh. She seems to be genuinely excited about it and has recommended that I should apply for the next round. I am about to finish my first draft at the moment, and have

been having thoughts on the next step. Being part of a meaningful outreach programme while steadily deciding the most appealing path I am going to take is the most luxury situation one would hope for.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

During my time here in Oxford, I have participated in various teaching and outreach programmes. I have been the college tutor for Materials undergrads for both Mansfield and Queen's college since my first year, and my responsibility is the polymer-related topics. I have assisted Study Higher, a university outreach programme, delivering classes to Y7-11 students in Banbury and Reading. I have also participated in the UNIQ+ programme ran by the university aiming for assisting graduate school application for less-represented groups as digital mentor, sharing my experience in higher degree application and my understanding to my research field. Outside of university, I have been part-time doing similar graduate school application consulting for a company back home in China. And throughout high school and undergraduate, I have been doing coaching works for the sports I have been doing since I was a kid, which built the foundation of my presentation skills targeting audience of different age groups and understating levels.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the near future, if I stay in the field of Materials Science, I would see myself either further pursuing my current research project if funding were to be found; if not, I would be in industry working on sustainable packaging using my polymer science and biomaterials knowledge. If I end up pursuing my other passion Forensics/Archaeological Science, I would find a postdoc position in UCL to work my way in the fields using my materials characterisation skills. Long-term wise, once I'm stable in the field I am working on, which would highly likely be either academia, packaging industry, working in a museum, or consulting for the police, I would start teaching while researching (if academia), initiating public engagement programmes, or volunteering in giving tours in the museum in my free time.

CV/Resume

 [CV-for-Science-Corps.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list

A friend or colleague

Any other comments/questions?

LinkedIn profile: <http://www.linkedin.com/in/zhaoying-ma-b52824239>

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